

A RESURGENT RIGHT SMELLS POWER AT THE CENTRE IN THE WAKE OF THE

BJP

on a roll

CONGRESS

on the ropes

■ By Prabhu Chawla

South of the Vindhyas, it was another country, resistant to the temptations of the House of Saffron. The charioteers and other mythologists of the right tried every method of proselytising in politics but in vain. It was a merciless land, and its refusal to give in to BJP had made the party so north Indian, and less national despite all those slogans about the nation. The south was elsewhere, inaccessible, incomprehensible.

Until Bookanakere Siddalingappa Yeddyurappa happened.

He is the author of the historic Deccan chronicle that is being celebrated as a text of national surge by the Sangh Parivar and dreaded as a script of impending doom by the Jeremiahs of the secular front. It is not in geography alone that BJP has gained; its acquisition of a brand new leader is the most definitive outcome of the election. Add Yeddy to Modi and the combination could be quite heady.

With such warriors—regional leaders who can make a national difference—in the vanguard, BJP is on the march, and suddenly, it

